

PSYCHOLOGY FOR LIFE AND WORK

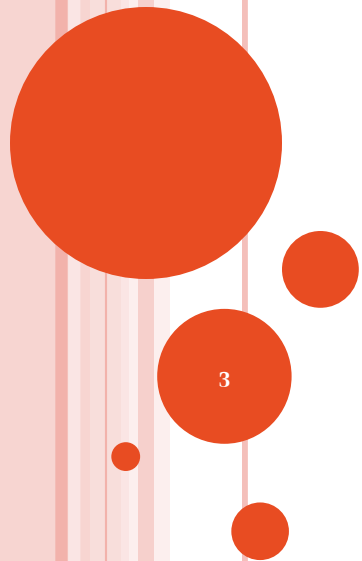
LECTURE 3: PERSONALITY

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OUTLINE FOR THE LECTURE

- Personality
 - Definition & Implications
 - Self-assessment: Your personality types
- Theoretical Approaches of Personality Development
 - Sample Applications

PERSONALITY



PERSONALITY

- Personality is a dynamic organization within an individual which leads to his/her **personal tendencies**.
- These tendencies are quite:
 - **Stable**
 - **Predictive** of their thoughts and behaviors



PERSONALITY & BEHAVIOR TENDENCIES

Version A

Mr. Blank is a graduate student in the Department of Economics and Social Science here at M.I.T. He has had three semesters of teaching experience in psychology at another college. This is his first semester teaching Ec. 70. He is 26 years old, a veteran, and married. People who know him consider him to be a rather cold person, industrious, critical, practical, and determined.

Version B

Mr. Blank is a graduate student in the Department of Economics and Social Science here at M.I.T. He has had three semesters of teaching experience in psychology at another college. This is his first semester teaching Ec. 70. He is 26 years old, a veteran, and married. People who know him consider him to be a very warm person, industrious, critical, practical, and determined.

LEARNING ACTIVITY: WHICH OF THESE IS PERSONALITY?



- Personality is quite **stable and predictive** of someone's tendencies in **general** situations.
 - A) Jill became very aggressive after being drunk. Normally, she's sweet and kind.
 - B) Jack was so anxious during a high-stake job interview that he was stammering. Normally, he is very confident.
 - C) Jan was very tired after a long week at work. She became more lenient than usual and agreed to give her children extra allowances.



SELF-ASSESSMENT

- Respond to the Ten-item Personality Inventory (i.e., TIPI; Gosling et al., 2002), developed based on the Big Five personality domains of:
 - Extraversion
 - Agreeableness
 - Conscientiousness
 - Neuroticism (Emotional *in*stability)
 - Openness to experience
- Please use a display name to maintain your privacy.

SELF-ASSESSMENT



○ TIPI Norms

Gender	Age	Extra-version	Agree- ableness	Conscien- tiousness	**Emo- tional stability**	Openness to Expe- rience
Male	15-20	3.79 (1.55)	4.47 (1.22)	4.41 (1.47)	4.61 (1.47)	5.43 (1.17)
	21-30	3.73 (1.54)	4.5 (1.2)	4.57 (1.39)	4.64 (1.46)	5.49 (1.13)
Female	15-20	4.06 (1.58)	4.73 (1.22)	4.52 (1.42)	4.07 (1.46)	5.58 (1.1)
	21-30	4.07 (1.61)	4.88 (1.19)	4.78 (1.41)	4.09 (1.45)	5.55 (1.12)

THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT



or



PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT: NATURE VS. NURTURE

Both nature & nurture are influential

Nature: Inborn
& Inherited

Nurture results from
experiences (e.g., parenting,
learning, socialization)

Nature is a pre-determining factor and sets
the initial limits for nurture influence.

THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

- 1) The genetic approach
- 2) The psychosocial theory of development
- 3) The learning approaches
- 4) The social cognitive approach
- 5) The humanistic approach



LEARNING ACTIVITIES: UNDERSTANDING PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

- While reviewing the personality theories, think about how well each is applicable to explaining “**the boastfulness**” of Zuneo, a character in Doraemon.

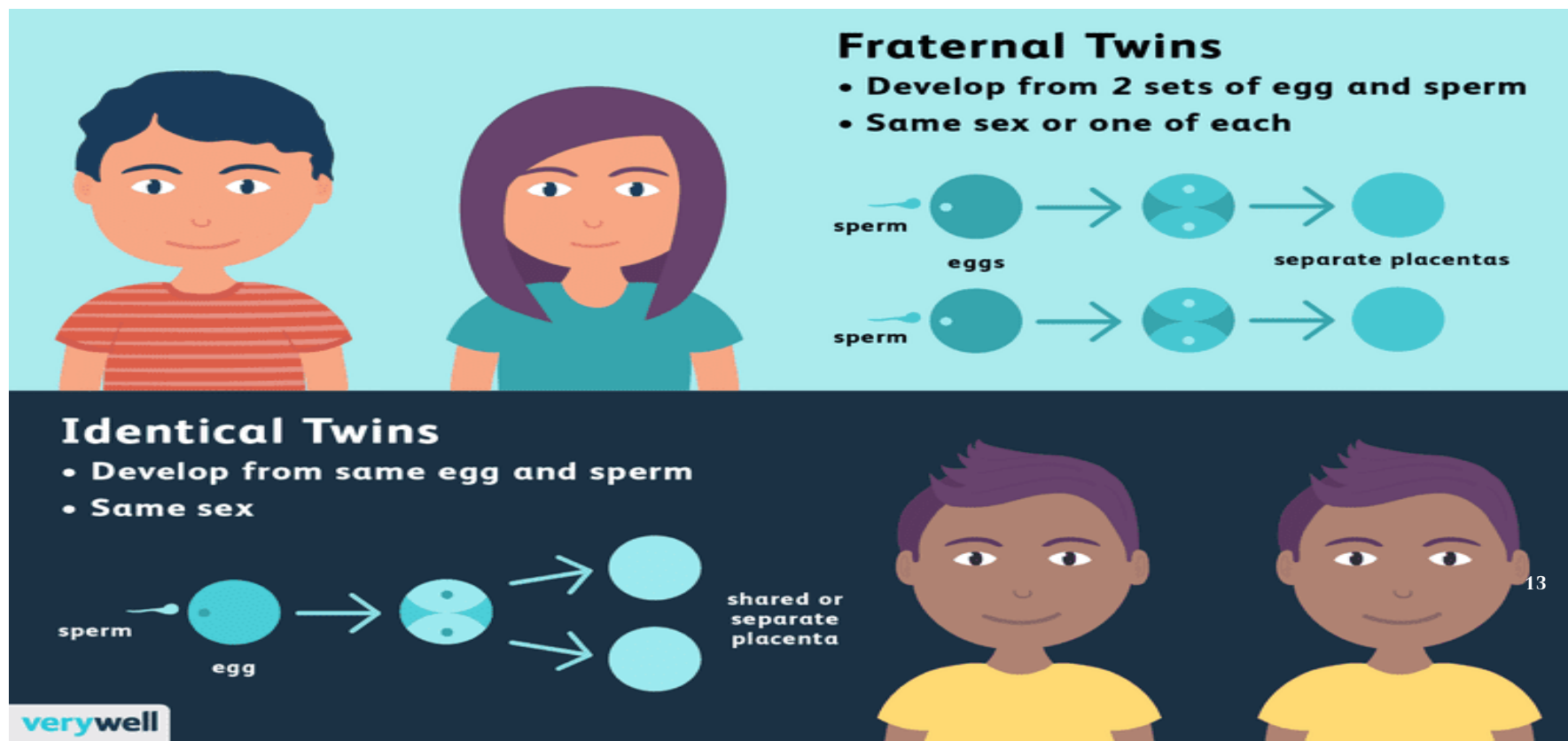


Approaches	Applicability (1: Min, 5: Max)	Explanation
1) Genetic		
2) Psychosocial Theory		
3) Behaviorism		
4) Social Cognitive Theory		
5) Humanistic Approach		

THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

○ 1) Genetic Approach

- Research evidence is generally gathered from twin studies.



THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

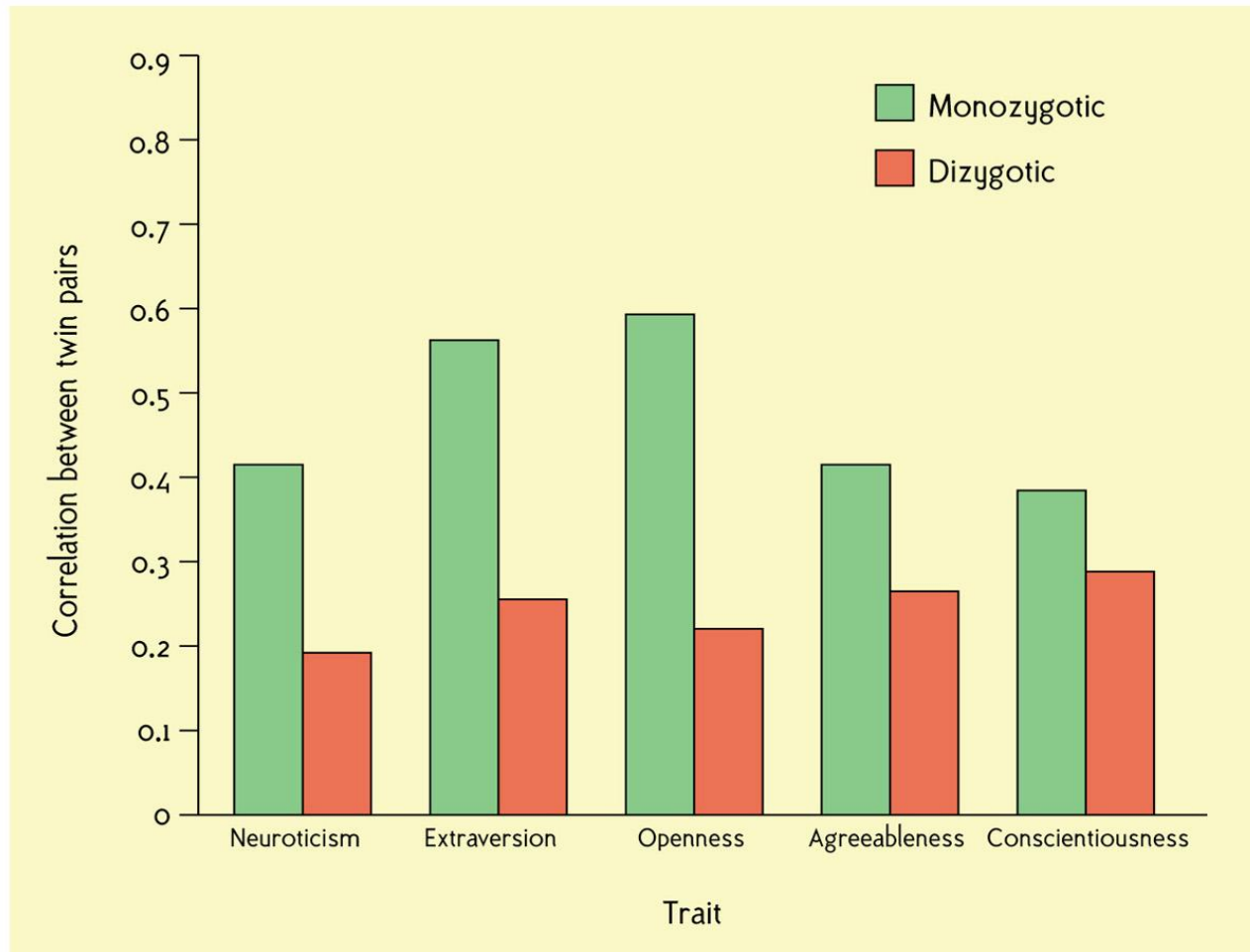


○ 1) Genetic Approach

- Generally, twins get exposed to similar environments (i.e., nurture).
- Still, when compared, identical twins have **more genetic similarities** (i.e., nature) than fraternal twins.
 - Identical twins are shown to be **more similar in their personality** than fraternal twins.
- The similarity is then attributed to **nature**.

THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

○ 1) Genetic Approach



THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

○ 1) Genetic Approach

- **Case studies** have been conducted on identical twins who were **separated at birth**.
- These studies reported **similarity** in the twins' personalities, despite their separations (and different environments/nurturance).
- These studies help confirm the influence of “**nature**”.

Born Together – Reared Apart



The Landmark Minnesota Twin Study

NANCY L. SEGAL

SAMPLE APPLICATION



- 1) Genetic Approach:
Application to Zuneo
 - Applicable to some degree.
 - Similar to Zuneo, his mother was boastful. Both Zuneo and his mother might have been prone to **narcissism** which was empirically shown to have some genetic contribution.

THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

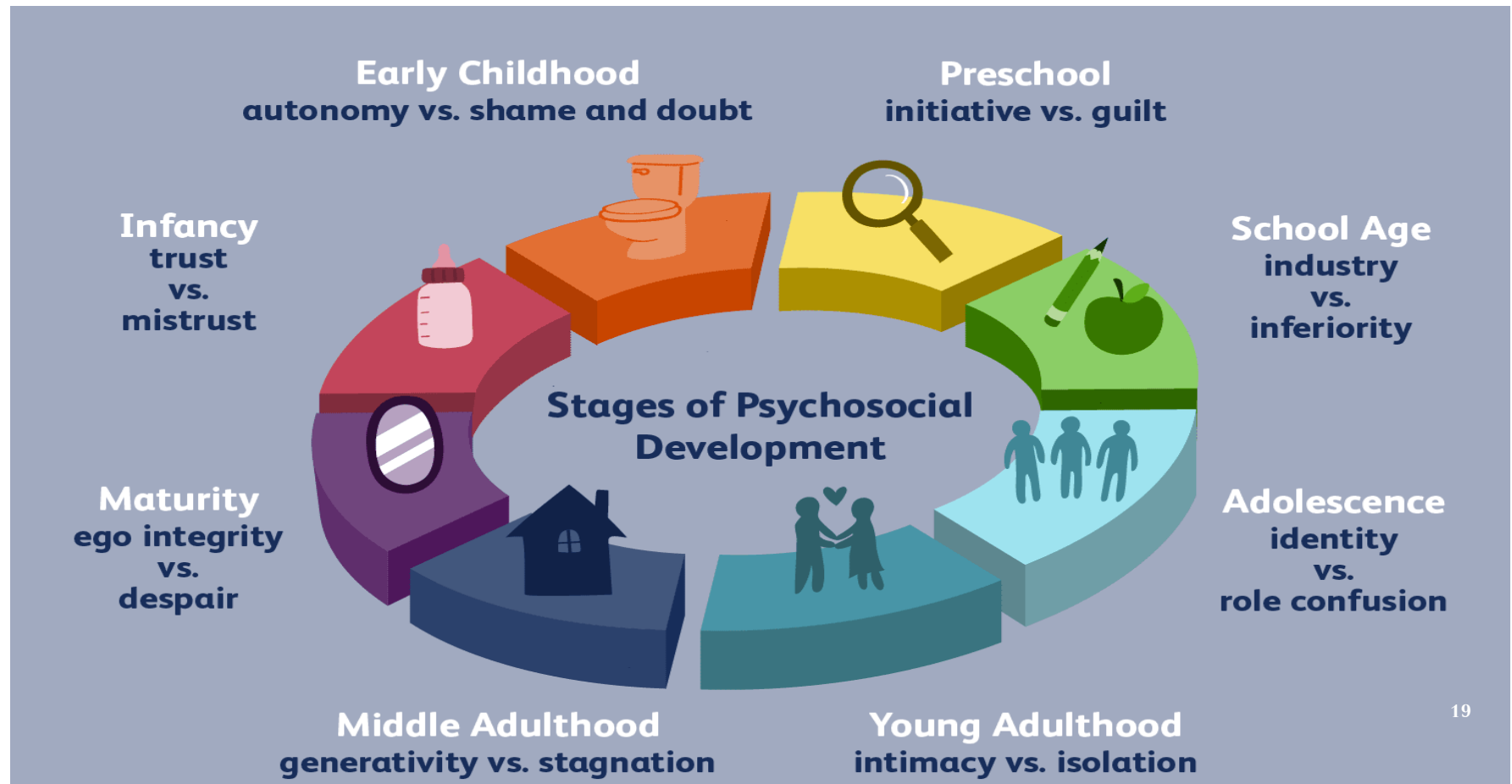
○ 2) Erikson's Psychosocial Theory of Development:

- Personality develops in a **predetermined** order through **8 stages**.
- During each stage, a person experiences **a psychosocial crisis** where his/her **needs** are in **conflict** with **societal demands/supports**.
- Successful completion of each stage results in a healthy personality (i.e., the acquisition of basic virtues/strengths).
- Failure to do so results in a reduced opportunity to complete **further stages**.

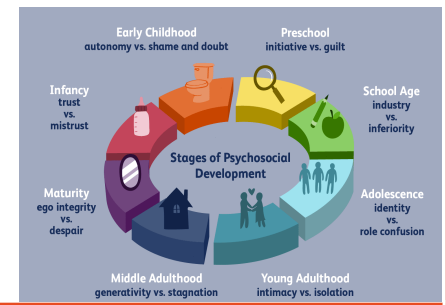


THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

2) Erikson's Psychosocial Theory of Development.



THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT



Age (Yrs)	Virtue/ Strength	Psychosocial Crisis
0-1½	Hope	Trust vs. Mistrust
1½-3	Will	Autonomy vs. Shame & Doubt
3-5	Purpose	Initiative vs. Guilt
5-12	Competence	Industry vs. Inferiority
12-18	Fidelity	Identity vs. Role Confusion
18-40	Love	Intimacy vs. Isolation
40-65	Care	Generativity vs. Stagnation
65 & more	Wisdom	Ego Integrity vs. Despair

SAMPLE APPLICATION



- 2) Erikson's Psychosocial Theory of Development:
Application to Zuneo
 - At school where the strength of competence was promoted, Zuneo did not seem to accomplish sufficient **“industry”** and could have felt **“inferior”**.
 - He might have had to **compensate** by boasting in order to gain the sense of **competence**.

THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

- 3) Behavioral Approach (Learning)
 - Focuses on the behavioral aspects of personalities.
 - Emphasizes **environmental influence** on these behaviors.
 - Relevant approaches:
 - The **Classical** Conditioning
 - The **Operant** Conditioning

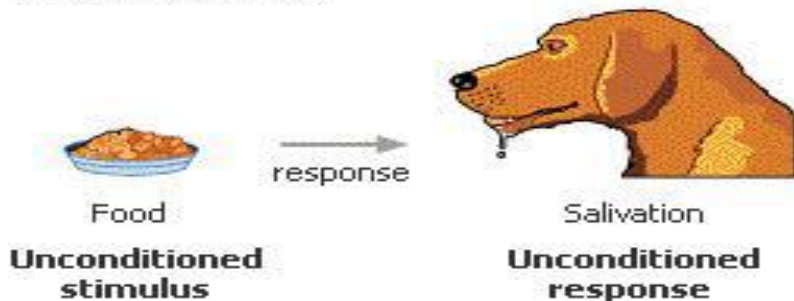


THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

○ 3.1) Behavioral Approach: Classical Conditioning (Pavlov)

- The personality (i.e., behavior) is developed through **repeatedly associating** a neutral stimulus with an unconditioned stimulus.
- Then, the previously neutral stimulus becomes the **conditioned stimulus** that elicits the **conditioned response** (i.e., behavior).

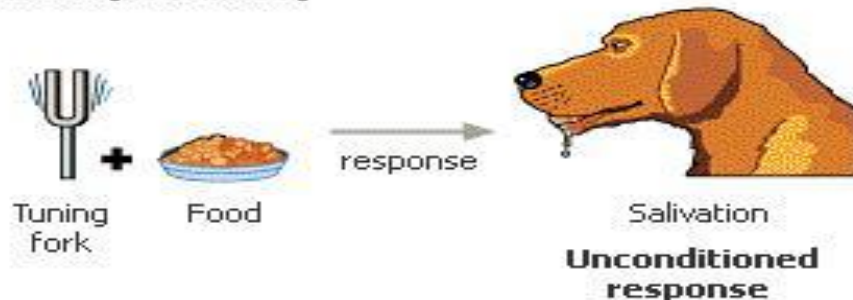
1. Before conditioning



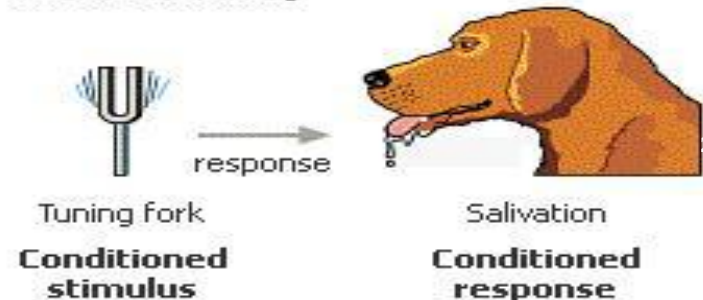
2. Before conditioning



3. During conditioning



4. After conditioning



THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

- 3.1) Behavioral approach: Classical Conditioning (Watson)
 - Here, a white rat, a **neutral stimulus** that elicited no fear response, was turned into a **conditioned stimulus** and elicited fearful responses when the rat was **repeatedly associated** with loud noises.

A flow-chart of this dastardly deed...

Before conditioning

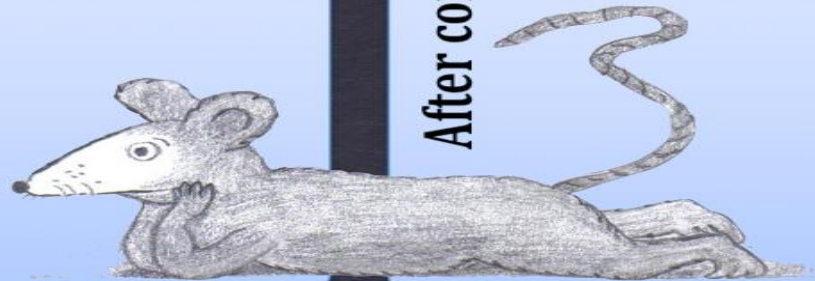
Neutral stimulus-
white rat (elicited no fear response)
Unconditioned stimulus -
loud noise (hammer striking steel bar)
which elicited
Unconditioned response - fear response, violently startled, crying, etc.

During conditioning

white rat (NS) presented on several occasions with the loud sound (UCS), which produced the child's fearful response (UCR)

After conditioning

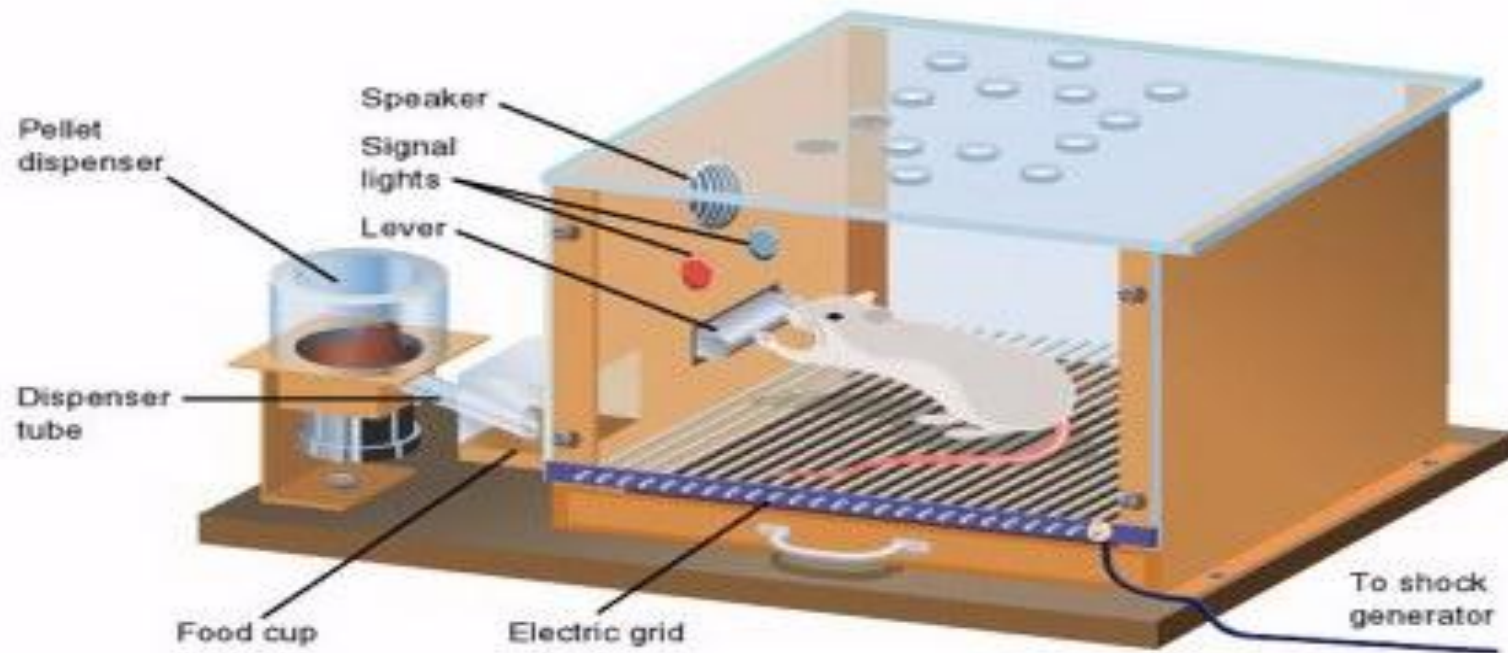
rat (now the CS) alone elicits the startled, fearful response (CR)



Classical Conditioning, Little Albert and the White Rat

THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

○ 3.2) Behavioral Approach: Operant Conditioning (Skinner)



THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

○ 3) Behavioral Approach: Operant Conditioning (Skinner)

- Personality is formed based on the **outcomes** in the environments.
- We learn to associate our behaviors with environmental outcomes and **increase/decrease** the behaviors, depending on whether the outcomes are **desirable or undesirable**.



SAMPLE: APPLICATION

- 3) Behavioral Approach:
Application to Zuneo
 - When he bragged, Zuneo was **rewarded** by his peers' attention and accommodation. So, he continued the boastfulness.



THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

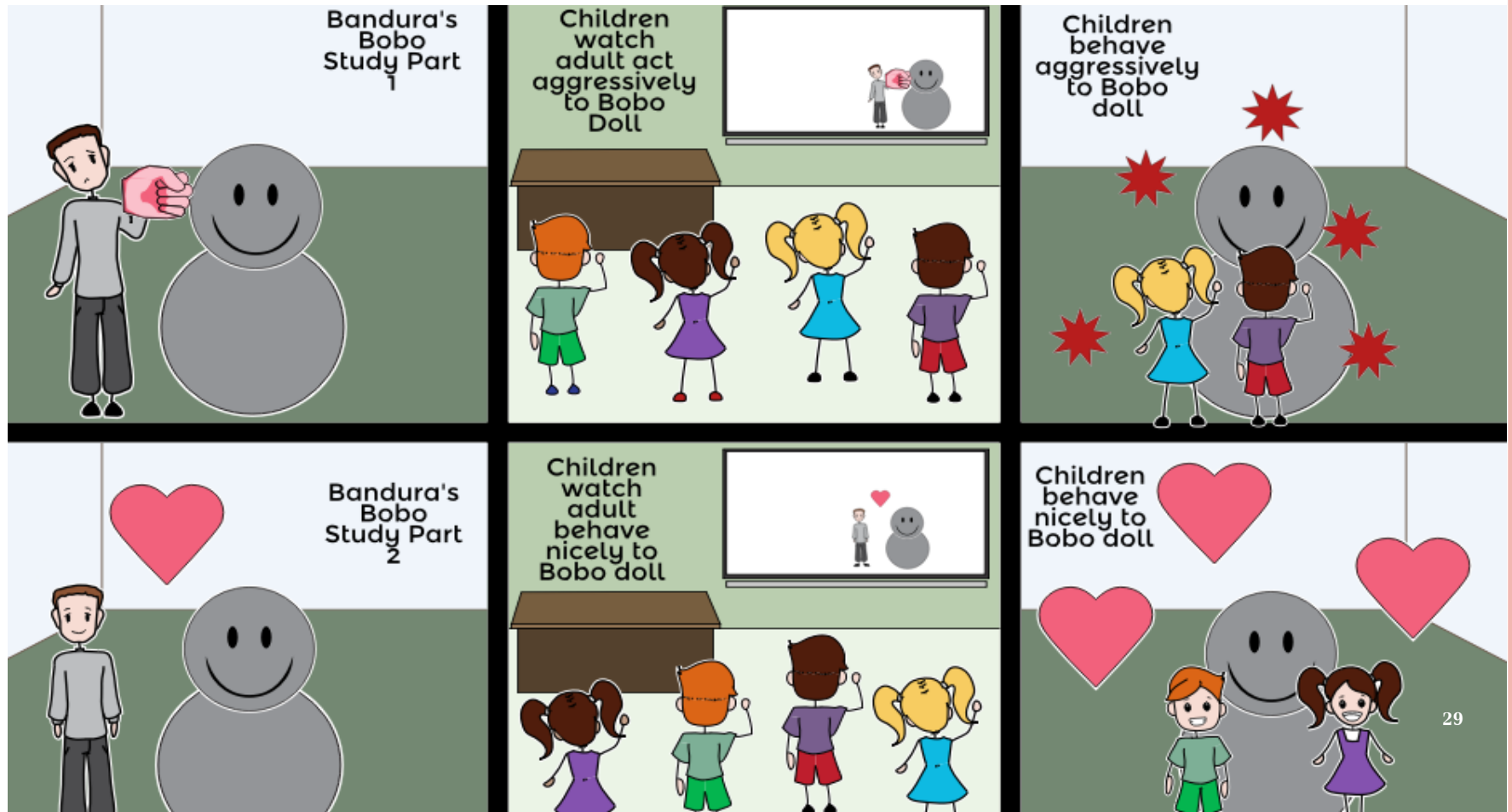
○ 4) Social Cognitive Approach:

- In addition to our environments, our **cognitive processes** (e.g., personal worldviews, values, expectations) contribute to behavioral engagement & subsequent personality development.
 - If we **value** social relationships, we are likely to be agreeable. When we do this repeatedly, agreeableness could become a part of our personality.
- Also, our personality is also influenced by what we **observe** from worthwhile models.



THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

○ 4) Social Cognitive Approach: Bobo Doll Study



SAMPLE: APPLICATION

- 4) Social Cognitive Approach:
Application to Zuneo
 - Zuneo could have **observed** his parents' boastfulness and imitated the behavior from them.



THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT



○ 5) Humanistic Approach

- We will reach our **full potentials** in personality development if we are allowed to grow and develop our personality in our **own unique ways**.
- “We are like an acorn; if provided with the **appropriate conditions**, we will automatically grow in positive ways, pushing naturally toward its **actualization** as an oak” (Rogers, 1986b).

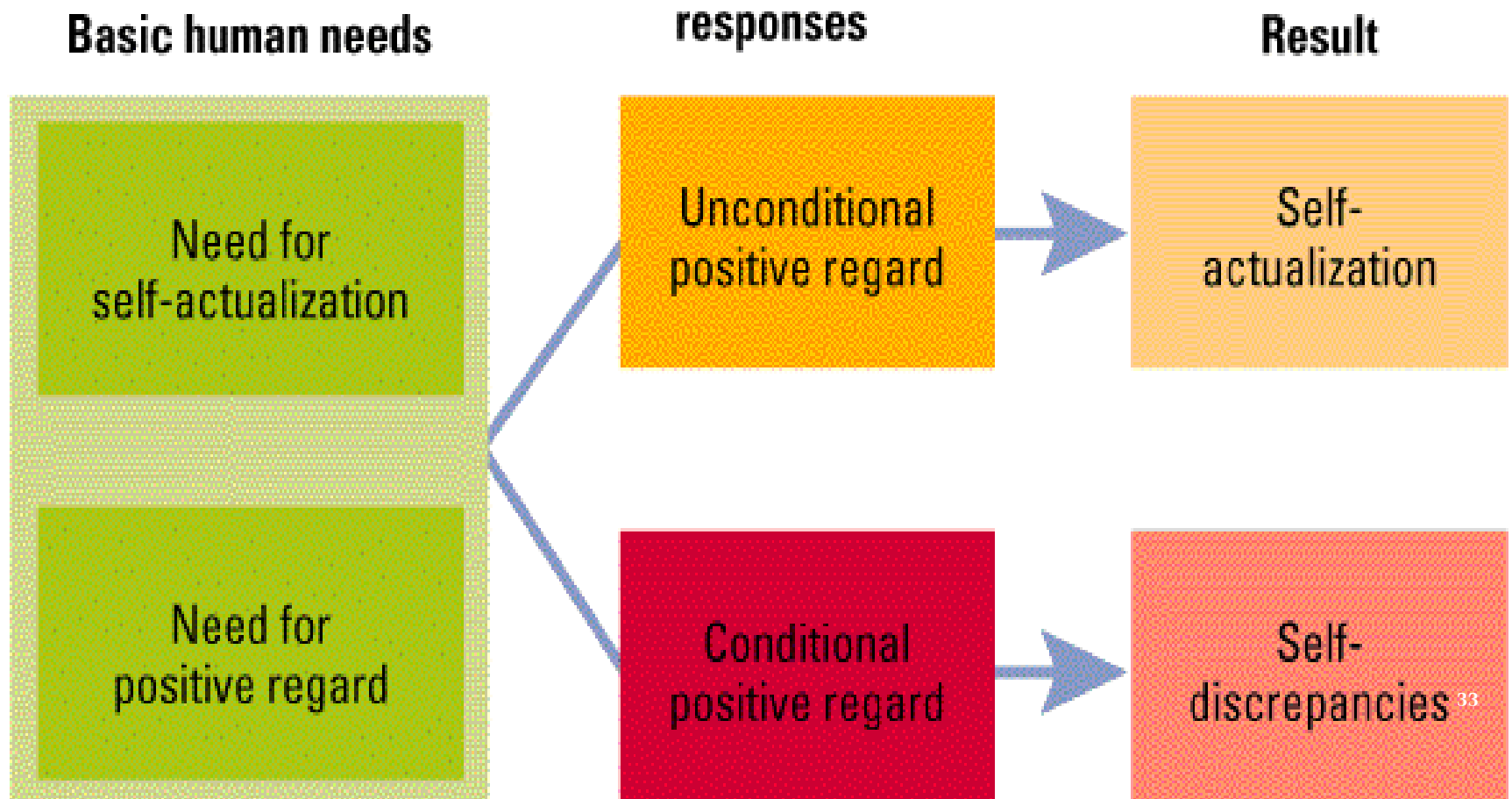
THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT



- 5) Humanistic Approach
 - Unfortunately, some of us have to **trade** our **needs for self-actualization** (i.e., to develop our unique personality) for our needs for **positive regards** (i.e., to be approved by our significant others by becoming whom they want us to be).
 - Then, a **gap** occurs between who we actually are and the personality we strive to become.
 - Then, **self-discrepancies** occur.

THEORETICAL APPROACHES OF PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

○ 5) Humanistic Approach



SAMPLE APPLICATION



○ 5) Humanistic Approach:

Application to Zuneo

- Zuneo was **yet** to find his own callings/potentials (i.e., true personality).
- Even when he did, his calling/potentials (e.g., gaming, painting) might not have been **supported** by his significant others.
- He might have had to try to adopt the personality he thought his parents would prefer (i.e., being superior and boastful).

LEARNING ACTIVITIES: UNDERSTANDING ZUNEO'S BOASTFULNESS



Approaches	Applicability (1: Min, 5: Max)	Explanations
1) Genetic	1	Genetic factors might have contributed to the overarching construct of narcissism, which was linked to boastfulness.
2) psychosocial	3-4	Zuneo might not have accomplished the task of being “industrial” and compensated by boastfulness.
3) Behaviorism	4-5	When he bragged, Zuneo was rewarded by his peers’ attention and accommodation.
4) Social Cognitive	3-4	Zuneo might have observed and imitated his parents’ interaction with others and their boastfulness.
5) Humanistic	4	Zuneo was yet to find his own callings/potentials so he simply adopted the personality he thought his parents would have preferred, being superior and boastfulness.

MEETING SUMMARY

- In this meeting, we discussed personality:
 - Its definition and characteristics
 - Sample personality classification: Big 5
 - Theoretical Approaches to Personality Development
 - Nature vs. nurture
 - Theories of personality developments

